

TB Tape

Version: 1.0.0 | Documentation date: 2026-08-10

Overview

Slows audio to silence and spins it back to normal speed with a motor curve you can draw yourself.

What this plug-in solves

TB Tape creates repeatable tape-stop and restart transitions without drawing clip automation. Stop and start can use different times and one reusable motor curve.

What you can expect

- Tape-style slowdown to digital silence
- Independent 0-2000 ms stop and start times
- Freehand or point-based motor curves with six shape shortcuts

How it works

Pause follows Stop Time to silence; Play follows Start Time back to normal speed. Pitch follows the same motor-speed change.

Draw or Points edits the 33-value Motor Curve, and six shortcuts provide starting shapes. Each transition latches the curve and saves it with presets and DAW state.

Quick start

- 1 Start from Init and set Stop Time and Start Time.
- 2 Choose a curve shortcut or draw the Motor Curve.
- 3 Trigger Play/Pause while audio repeats, adjust the motion, compare with Bypass, and save the result when needed.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Play / Pause

Pause slows the tape motor to silence; Play returns it to normal speed. Reversing direction continues from the current motor speed.

Stop Time and Start Time

Set braking and spin-up independently from 0 to 2000 ms. Short values make abrupt edits; longer values create a clear sweep.

Motor Curve

Draw edits 33 values and Points edits nodes. Six shape shortcuts provide quick starting curves while the controls remain pinned.

Programs and state

Eight factory presets and the TB TAPE plate provide recall, save, undo, and redo; the curve is stored with DAW state.

Bypass

Latency-aligned bypass provides a direct comparison without a timing jump and remains separate from Play/Pause.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and let the active stop or start transition finish before judging the difference.
Play	Requests normal playback or starts the tape-motor slowdown when switched to Pause. Trigger it on a clear musical event and leave enough time for the selected stop or start transition to finish.
Program	Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one control at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source.
Start Time	Sets how long the tape motor takes to accelerate from silence to normal speed. Trigger Play early enough that normal speed returns at the intended musical point.
Stop Time	Sets how long the tape motor takes to slow from normal speed to silence. Loop the transition and set the braking length before refining the Motor Curve.

Motor Curve, Draw, Points, and the six curve shortcuts are panel controls stored with the plug-in state; they are described in the interface section rather than repeated as host-visible parameter rows.

Practical uses

End-of-section tape stop

- Set Stop Time and choose Linear or Motor Drag.
- Automate Play to Pause on the final beat.
- Leave enough time for the motor to reach silence.

Expected result: Pitch and speed fall to a clean stop without clip automation.

Slow restart

- Choose a longer Start Time than Stop Time.
- Use S-Curve or draw a gentle lower half.
- Press Play before the next phrase and place the trigger early enough for full-speed recovery.

Expected result: The source spins back up gradually and reaches normal speed at the intended musical point.

Custom motor contour

- Use Draw or Points to create one controlled rise and dip inside the curve.
- Keep the controls pinned and begin with moderate transition times.
- Audition on sustained material before using it on complex transients.

Expected result: The transition follows a repeatable custom speed path without adding delay repeats or saturation.

Common pitfalls

The effect is Tape Stop, not Tape Delay; it does not create repeats or feedback. Use Play/Pause and the motor timing controls for transitions; use a separate delay when repeats are required.

Very short times or abrupt curve corners can sound intentionally sharp; use a smoother curve when clicks or hard pitch jumps are distracting. Lengthen the transition or smooth the nearby curve values before changing the rest of the sound.

The plug-in reports seven samples of latency, so judge bypass and active playback inside a latency-compensated host. Keep host delay compensation enabled and avoid moving the plug-in between compensated and uncompensated paths during comparison.

Automated tests pass; manual DAW checks remain pending. Verify automation, recall, bypass, and sound before critical use.